

Rajdev Kaur Brar

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Education

PhD, Agricultural and Resource Economics - University of California, Berkeley (Year 4)	2022 - present
MA, Economics (Concentration in Development Studies) - McGill University	2014 – 2016
BA, Economics and International Development Studies (double major) - McGill University	2011 - 2014

Publications

Brar, R., Buehren, N., Papineni, S., & Sulaiman, M. (2026). Resisting social conformity pressure: Impact of a gender norms intervention for adolescents in Somalia. *Journal of Development Economics*, 103713.

Work in progress

“Information search among high school students in India”- with Rubina Hundal
“Testing a budgeting intervention to address seasonal hunger”- with Kelsey Jack, Supreet Kaur, Nicholas Swanson
“Bundled agricultural services for farmers in Egypt”- with Amira El-Shal, Jeremy Magruder
“Household-level impacts of increasing women’s financial control in Côte d’Ivoire”- with Aletheia Donald

Research experience

Research Assistant for Kelsey Jack, Supreet Kaur UC Berkeley- Department of Economics	Berkeley, USA 2024 - present
Research Assistant for Jeremy Magruder, Brian Wright UC Berkeley- Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics	Berkeley, USA 2023 - present
Research Analyst for Niklas Buehren, Sreelakshmi Papineni, Laura Chioda The World Bank- Africa Gender Innovation Lab The World Bank- Office of Vice President: Equitable Growth, Finance, Institutions	Washington, DC, USA 2019 - 2025 2018-9
Research Associate for Esther Duflo, Abhijit Banerjee, Arun Chandrasekhar, John Floretta, Matthew Jackson, Harini Kannan, Anna Schrimpf, Maheshwor Shrestha The Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) South Asia	New Delhi, India 2016-8

Teaching experience

Graduate Student Instructor at UC Berkeley: Economic Development- Marco Gonzalez-Navarro	2023
Reader at UC Berkeley: Economic Development (M. Gonzalez-Navarro), Econometrics (S. Villas-Boas)	2022-3
Teaching Assistant at McGill University International Trade (W. Watson), Macroeconomics (E. Sen-Choudhury), Economic Crises (N. Sayour)	2014-5

Research grants | Total amount: 362,580 USD

J-PAL Learning for All Initiative- with Rubina Hundal	51,740 USD	2026
Weiss Fund Pilot Grant- with Rubina Hundal	13,337 USD	2026
GiveWell Revealed Preferences Grant- with Wilson King	55,610 USD	2026
Digital Agricultural Innovations and Services Initiative- with Amira El-Shal, Jeremy Magruder	74,847 USD	2025
Solutions and Advancements through Research in Water and Air- with Aprajit Mahajan, Piyush Gandhi	45,000 USD	2025
Hub of Advance Policy Innovation for the Environment- with Amira El-Shal, Jeremy Magruder	74,946 USD	2025
Agricultural and Resource Economics Department Travel Grant	1,500 USD	2024
Solutions and Advancements through Research in Water and Air- with Aprajit Mahajan	30,000 USD	2024
Weiss Fund Travel and Exploratory Grant- with Rubina Hundal	7,000 USD	2024
CEGA Fall 2023 Development Economics Challenge Travel Grant	3,600 USD	2023
Weiss Fund Travel and Exploratory Grant- with Jeremy Magruder	5,000 USD	2023

Conferences and presentations

Advances with Field Experiments (AFE)- University of Chicago (<i>scheduled</i>)	2026
Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP) EdDev Community Group (<i>scheduled</i>)	2026
Nova School of Business and Economics- NOVAFRICA Conference on Economic Development (<i>scheduled</i>)	2026
UC Berkeley- Development Lunch Seminar, Department Development Workshop (x2)	2025, 2026
Stanford University- Pacific Conference for Development Economics	2024
The World Bank- Africa Gender Innovation Lab Team Seminar (x3)	2021, 2022

Policy briefs and blog posts

[World Bank Policy Brief] “Engaging men for women’s economic empowerment: Overview of the evidence”- World Bank Africa Gender Innovation Lab. (2023) Rachael Pierotti, Clara Delavallade, Rajdev Brar.
[World Bank Blog] “Understanding the dynamics of gender norms in Somalia: A behavioral approach”.
World Bank Blog: Let’s Talk Development. Rajdev Brar, Niklas Buehren, Sreelakshmi Papineni, Munshi Sulaiman. 2023.

Skills

Software: Stata, R, SurveyCTO (ODK), LaTeX, Tableau, ArcGIS (basic), Python (basic)
Languages: English (native), Panjabi (native), Hindi (fluent)